

COMMON SYMPTOMS VS. WARNING SIGNS

Understanding the Difference

Many pregnancy symptoms are normal. However, some symptoms may indicate complications requiring prompt medical evaluation. Learning to distinguish between common discomforts and warning signs is an important part of prenatal health.

Common Symptoms

- Mild nausea and vomiting, especially in the first trimester
- Light spotting in early pregnancy (implantation bleeding)
- Mild breast tenderness
- Fatigue and sleepiness
- Constipation and bloating
- Mild back pain
- Mild swelling of feet and ankles
- Heartburn and indigestion
- Braxton Hicks contractions (mild, irregular)

Fetal Development Highlights

- By week 28, the baby can open and close their eyes.
- By week 32, the baby practices breathing movements.
- By week 36, the baby is considered late preterm.
- By week 40, the baby is considered full term and ready for birth.

Warning Signs – Contact a Healthcare Provider

- Heavy vaginal bleeding at any point in pregnancy
- Severe abdominal pain or cramping
- Severe nausea and vomiting preventing fluid intake (hyperemesis gravidarum)

- Sudden severe headache, vision changes, or swelling of face or hands (possible preeclampsia)
- Fever over 100.4°F (38°C)
- Burning or pain with urination (possible urinary tract infection)
- Decreased or absent fetal movement after 24 weeks
- Signs of preterm labor before 37 weeks (regular contractions, pelvic pressure)
- Sudden shortness of breath or chest pain

Key Takeaway

When in doubt, contact your healthcare provider. It is always safer to seek guidance than to ignore a symptom that could indicate a complication.

Bloom provides educational guidance only. Always consult with a qualified healthcare professional for personalized medical advice.

Educational content informed by American College of Obstetricians and Gynecologists. (n.d.). Warning signs during pregnancy. Mayo Clinic. (2023).
Pregnancy symptoms: Top 11 early signs. March of Dimes. (2020). Signs and symptoms of pregnancy complications.